

Carmen Love: Hello?

Detective Freeman: Carman Love.

Carmen Love: Yes, sir.

Detective Freeman: Steve Freeman

Carmen Love: Yes, sir

Detective Freeman: How are you doing

Carmen Love: good how you doing

Detective Freeman: All right, so listen, um, had a lady come in, her name is uh, Lauren Deal, you know Lauren Deal

Carmen Love: I do

Detective Freeman: Okay, she um can you tell me a little bit about last night, about what uh where y'all went

Carmen Love: Sure

Detective Freeman: Last night

Carmen Love: Um, so well yesterday afternoon. She had messaged me through Messenger and asked if I was going out or anything and I never responded till later on and um me and James got in the car and went up to Goodfellas to have some dinner. Lauren messaged me um and said that she was right at the hospital. I said well come on. You can come on up here whatever. We are here at goodfellas. So she messaged me and then asked me if I'd ride with her to get her ear pierced. I didn't see it then. She called and said she was going to get her ear pierced really quick um I think at Pandora's Box and then she'd be up there. So she text messaged me when she got there. I walked outside met her and she walked back in. Um we sat there and ate dinner and we hung out for a little bit. then she wanted to ride with us over to the Pit Stop so we got in the car. Me, James, Lauren and a friend of James. We got in the car and we went, we were headed to the pit stop and someone, one of James's friends called and said there was no one there so they wanted to go to Schoolys. So we pulled into Schoolys. We walked inside. We stayed for, I don't know possibly an hour and a half.

Detective Freeman: Okay

Carmen Love: Two hours, if that, maybe an hour and a half.

Detective Freeman: OK

Carmen Love: Um, when I went to leave, um I asked Lauren to come with us, that's because I was driving, and I wanted to make sure she got home okay. And she was not ready to go, and we were, and I said Lauren come on let's get in the car. I got James, I got Pete and we kept telling her come on, she wouldn't leave. James walked up to her and said come on go with us. She said no, I'm gonna stay here. um I'll call you. Send me the address and I'll call you if I need a ride or if I need to however I can get there. I said okay so I sent her the address and we left.¹

Detective Freeman: Okay did she say...?

Carmen Love: went home...

Detective Freeman: Why she wanted to stay or anything like that?

Carmen Love: I know I mean when I, I mean there was a there was like a couple there's there was a few people in there, there was two guys in there that I've never met before

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: Um, younger than me, and they, they were talking to her, and she seemed like she was fine um, but they had walked off when I I walked up to her and was telling her come on, let's go you know she needed a ride, and they walked off I didn't see them didn't never speak to them um I mean I, I could possibly know what they look like.²

Detective Freeman: Ok

Carmen Love: but they were younger. I think one of them had a little bit longer hair not long hair but you know what I mean how³

Detective Freeman: right

Carmen Love: kids weared it now

Detective Freeman: okay

¹ Peter West left the bar by himself at around 12:36. He did not leave with Carmen and James. It isn't believed that Carmen Love drove either, as she almost fell down at the bar a couple of times, having to be caught by James Morrison.

² Here, Carmen describes two younger guys. The Defendant would not be mistaken for a younger guy.

³ Excludes the Defendant as he is bald.

Carmen Love: um and uh so and then when, I left there she was standing at the table just standing there smoking a cigarette by herself, and she said that she would call if she needed to ride ⁴

Detective Freeman: all right

Carmen Love: so, we left

Detective Freeman: So I mean was was she intoxicated do you think she knew you know what she was doing or

Carmen Love: I do think she knew what she was doing. She has, she had been drinking, yes

Detective Freeman: yeah

Carmen Love: um, but um she wasn't like overly intoxicated

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: Now not, not at the time that I left

Detective Freeman: All right, so how long have you known Lauren?

Carmen Love: No more than my whole life.⁵

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: somehow or another um I don't know if it's like I'm not real sure they always say that we are kin.

Detective Freeman: um huh

Carmen Love: like long distance

Detective Freeman: oh ok

Carmen Love: um, but Lauren's brothers, and they used to live down the street from us, um, or her cousin used to live down the street from us, so they would go over there on Kendell Drive and hang out, so I've known Lauren, Lauren's younger than me, but I've known her for probably about I don't know 15 years Steve.

⁴ Carmen Love says explicitly that Lauren Deal is standing by herself smoking a cigarette when she leaves. She is not, nor has she said that she has been hanging out with three guys, with one of them being older and bald.

⁵ Known her for her whole life and is willing to change her story to whatever is needed, as can be seen in the interview with the Private Detective.

Detective Freeman: Ok

Carmen Love: 15 18 years, possibly longer than that 20 some years.

Detective Freeman: All right, all right, all right, so did so just those two guys all you saw were hanging out with those two guys? That was, nobody else that you know that she was hanging out with or?

Carmen Love: No, I mean like she hung out with me, James, and you know Pete. We were all standing at the table, and she would sit there and talk to us, um, There was other friend there named Joseph. I do know that she was I mean, she talked to him.⁶

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: But he was a mutual friend, um, I forgot about that, but he's a mutual friend. There were a bunch of people around, you know, in there.

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: so that I knew, but I do know that Joseph and her had a conversation her and James did, uh, her and Pete spoke briefly, but you know.

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: Then I seen those two guys talking to her that I've never seen before, but that was right when we were going to leave, and she said she wanted to stay, that she was fine, she hadn't, you know, she can drive or whatever.⁷

Detective Freeman: Right

Carmen Love: and I said all right let me know if you need a ride. Just call me. James even told her he would ride back up there with me to get her and so. But I mean I do remember like Joseph being in there. Me, James, Pete, uh and honestly I probably can't tell you any names of anyone else because there wasn't a lot of people there anyways but there wasn't a lot of people I knew.⁸

Detective Freeman: right, okay okay all right then well, have you talked to Lauren since

⁶ When Carmen left, and even a bit after Lauren Deal, DeMarco did not speak with them. Not even before handing him her keys/wallet. Carmen Love should not even know that name. We see the introduction when Allen points at him, saying that he is the DD and he (Allen) isn't going to drive Deal anywhere.

⁷ Lauren's car was not even at Schoolys. She rode with James and Carmen. It appears there is a focus on not mentioning DeMarco in a negative light, but on these "two other guys" she brings up; she can't describe them, as she had only been told about them.

⁸ Two responses earlier, she said the exact opposite.

Carmen Love: I haven't

Detective Freeman: Last night

Carmen Love: No. You know, earlier, no earlier, I was uh laying there, we were laying in the bed watching TV and I thought I need to text her to see if she's okay, and I checked my messenger and then Chloe called, and I just and it cross it is I mean it just kind of slipped my mind.⁹

Detective Freeman: ok

Carmen Love: And I didn't, but I haven't spoken to her since

Detective Freeman: All right, all right, she, I mean, she reported she was assaulted last night, so that's why I'm just trying to find out who, um.

Carmen Love: ok

Detective Freeman: Who are these other guys, and stuff, so, um.

Carmen Love: Okay.

Detective Freeman: Anyway

Carmen Love: Does she not know the names of them?

Detective Freeman: Yeah, well, do you know a guy named, uh, Ben Allen by chance?

Carmen Love: unmmmm – Ben Allen?

Detective Freeman: yeah

Carmen Love: Um nope. Doesn't it doesn't ring a bell.¹⁰

Detective Freeman: Okay, all right.

Carmen Love: I mean, I could maybe think about it, but I,

Detective Freeman: Okay

Carmen Love: if I've seen his face, maybe

Detective Freeman: Right.

⁹ Notice it just slipped her mind, and not that she was worried all day trying to get a hold of her. Two very different statements. Also, notice how Freeman doesn't have to ask who Chloe is when she is mentioned.

¹⁰ Carmen Love has no idea who the Defendant is, even though Lauren Deal told Freeman they were all drinking together, but she somehow knows the name Joseph (DeMarco).

Carmen Love: But I don't... it doesn't ring a bell.

Detective Freeman: Okay, okay, all right then. Yeah, well, um, well, appreciate you talking to me. That's all I needed.

Carmen Love: Any time.

Detective Freeman: Just needed to find out what uh what I mean she's never had any kind of uh issues in the past um uh with drugs or alcohol you mean that that you're aware of?

Carmen Love: Not that I'm aware of you.

Detective Freeman: OK.

Carmen Love: I mean, I... not that I'm aware of

Detective Freeman: Right

Carmen Love: I know her brother has struggled with addiction off and on, and uh, you know, she gets very upset with him, you know. She went through that, but no, not that I've never seen Lauren, uh, use any of that type of drugs.

Detective Freeman: Ok.

Carmen Love: To my acknowledgment.

Detective Freeman: Right. Yeah. All right, well, Carmen, I appreciate it.

Carmen Love: No problem.

Detective Freeman: Alright.

Carmen Love: You need anything else? Just let me know.

Detective Freeman: I'll do it. I appreciate it. I'll talk to you later. ¹¹

Carmen Love: All right.

Detective Freeman: All right.

Carmen Love: Thanks, Steve. All right.

Detective Freeman: All right, bye.

¹¹ Notice the familiarity in this conversation with the interviewee, even asking a question earlier.